

BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS
SPECIAL MEETING
OCTOBER 20, 2025
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PRESENT: Mayor William L. Lewis, Jr.; Commissioners Brenda Wilson, Danny Walsh, Tyrone Cantey, Mark Larkin, and Cynthia Evans-Robinson

STAFF

PRESENT: City Manager Chris McGee; Assistant City Manager Cindy Morgan; City Attorney Troy Smith; Finance Director Kimberly Walters; Public Information Officer Greta Meadows; and City Clerk Mary Weigl

After notice duly given, Mayor Will Lewis called the special meeting of the Havelock Board of Commissioners to order at 7:01 a.m. on October 20, 2025, at Havelock City Hall with a quorum present.

CLOSED SESSION:

NCGS 143.318.11 (a)(6) – PERSONNEL MATTERS

A Commissioner's motion and a second was sought to go into closed session under NCGS 143-318.11(a)(6) – to discuss a personnel matter.

At this time, Commissioner Cantey **moved to go into closed session under NCGS 143-318.11 (a)(6) to discuss a personnel matter.** Commissioner Larkin seconded and the motion carried unanimously. (5-0) The Board entered closed session at 7:02 a.m.

OPEN SESSION

The Board exited closed session at 7:14 a.m. Commissioner Larkin **moved to go back into open session.** Commissioner Walsh seconded and the motion carried unanimously. (5-0)

At this time, Commissioner Larkin made a **motion to approve the severance agreement and release between the City of Havelock and Christopher W. McGee as presented.** Commissioner Cantey seconded, and the motion carried unanimously. (5-0)

Subsequently, Commissioner Walsh **made a motion to allocate \$287,415.19 (\$214,608.43 Salary; \$26,074.92 Retirement; \$26,307.07 Vacation; and \$20,424.77 FICA) from General Fund – Fund Balance to cover the noted expenses associated with this agreement.** Commissioner Wilson seconded and the motion carried unanimously. (5-0)

At 7:17 a.m., Mayor Lewis recessed the meeting to allow Staff time to review and execute the necessary documents related to this action.

Mayor Lewis recalled the meeting to order at 7:25 a.m.

INTERIM CITY MANAGER DISCUSSION

The Board held a discussion regarding options and next steps for appointing an interim city manager and beginning the process of hiring a new city manager.

It was noted that Assistant City Manager Cindy Morgan is not interested in serving as Interim City Manager for a period of 9–12 months due to her existing responsibilities. The Board discussed several options for interim management, with the preferred approach being to hire an interim city manager from a pool of retired city managers. Becky Veazey and Rob Schneider were identified as resources who can provide advice and contacts for potential candidates. Mr. Schneider manages the League of Municipalities Manager Roll Call and contact information has been forwarded by Chris McGee.

During the interim period, it was noted that someone must be authorized to sign official documents. The Board discussed that Mayor Lewis would serve as the City's chief executive during this time, with authority to sign personnel actions, contracts, and related documents as needed.

Interim city manager contracts are typically drafted by the individual manager, specifying limited in-person hours and remote availability to remain within retirement benefit limits. Compensation

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for such contracts can vary, ranging from several thousand dollars up to approximately \$10,000 per month.

Department heads and staff will continue to carry out existing projects and operations during the interim period. The Board discussed options for managing the recruitment process and agreed that the current Human Resources department lacks sufficient capacity to manage the search internally. It was recommended that the city hire an external contractor to conduct the search. The MAPS Group has been used previously, though it now has a new president. Other statewide organizations may also be considered. Any expenses related to the search process will be funded through the General Fund.

The Board emphasized the need to obtain detailed information on interim city manager options, including potential candidates and the process for contract negotiation. Information is also needed on the recruitment process for a permanent city manager. The duration of this process—estimated to take 9–12 months—will influence the type of interim appointment made.

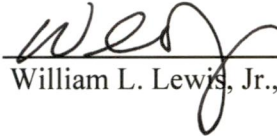
Staff was directed to begin gathering information on interim city manager options and potential recruitment firms. The Board anticipates receiving this data within approximately two weeks. A special meeting will be scheduled to review the information and discuss next steps, with potential dates ranging between October 31 and November 7. Following a review of individual schedules, the Board tentatively agreed to hold a special meeting on Monday, November 3, at 7:00 p.m. If sufficient information is not yet available, the meeting will not be set. Should no meeting occur prior to the November 13 retreat, the discussion will be added to the retreat agenda, with the understanding that the retreat may extend beyond its originally planned duration. The Board anticipates these discussions will require one to two hours.

ADJOURNMENT/RECESS

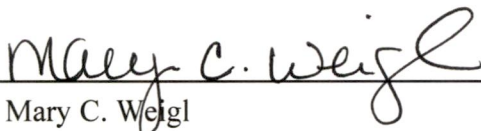
Commissioner Larkin **moved to adjourn the meeting.** Commissioner Wilson seconded and the motion carried unanimously. (5-0)

The meeting adjourned at 7:41 a.m.

Date approved: Nov. 24, 2025


William L. Lewis, Jr., Mayor

Attest:


Mary C. Weigl
City Clerk